

LORRAINE MERCADO

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 10+ years of experience in systems, compliance, and sensitive data management. Skilled in AWS cloud security, DevSecOps, IAM, and incident response, with a business-first approach to reducing risk and strengthening security controls.

SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, IAM, VPC, EC2, S3, Systems Manager, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Athena, ECR

Tools & Automation: tfsec, Suricata, Sysmon, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nikto, Python, PowerShell, GitHub Actions, Docker

Systems: Linux, Ubuntu, Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy

Certifications: Amazon Cloud Practitioner, 2026 • SHRM Senior Certified Professional (SHRM-SCP), 2023 • SHRM Certified Professional (SHRM-CP), 2022

PROJECTS

Secure AWS Infrastructure & DevSecOps Pipeline

2026

- Architected AWS infrastructure with Terraform, including VPC segmentation, security groups, EC2, Systems Manager, and VPC Flow Logs to create a secure and auditable cloud environment.
- Integrated tfsec with GitHub Actions to scan Infrastructure-as-Code on push and block insecure configurations from passing the CI/CD security quality gate.
- Remediated security findings involving S3 public access, encryption, versioning, security groups, and CloudWatch logging, applying vulnerability management, Zero Trust, and least-privilege principles to strengthen cloud security posture.

Cloud Incident Investigation & Response

2026

- Investigated simulated AWS incidents using CloudTrail and Athena to trace suspicious events, identities, source addresses, and affected resources.
- Performed log analysis to reconstruct attacker activity and support incident response, documenting findings, business risks, containment actions, and remediation recommendations.

Enterprise Active Directory & Identity Management

2026

- Deployed a Windows Server Domain Controller with Active Directory, Organizational Units, and Group Policy; automated user provisioning with PowerShell.
- Applied centralized role-based access control (RBAC) and least-privilege policies and integrated Linux endpoints with Active Directory to support secure enterprise authentication.

Security Automation & Threat Detection

2026

- Developed Python tools to automate log analysis, detect brute-force activity, audit processes, and generate structured security reports to support security operations.
- Configured Suricata and Sysmon detection rules to identify suspicious network and endpoint activity and support incident investigation.

EXPERIENCE

Systems Administration Manager | Innovation Charter School | New York, NY

Oct 2021 – Jul 2024

- Managed enterprise systems and sensitive personnel data, strengthening data accuracy, access controls, regulatory compliance, and audit readiness.
- Reconciled financial and operational data across multiple platforms and administered secure processes for confidential testing and education records.

Human Resources & Payroll Administrator | SKF Electrical Corp. | New York, NY

Sep 2020 – Dec 2020

- Implemented a paperless records system that reduced data exposure, improved auditability, saved approximately \$120,000 annually, and reduced time-to-hire by 50%.
- Managed sensitive payroll and employee data and supported regulatory audits, documentation, and internal controls.

Executive Assistant | Moaddel Law Firm | Los Angeles, CA

Feb 2017 – Jul 2018

- Supported deployment, configuration, and troubleshooting of servers, desktops, networks, and communication systems across business operations.
- Implemented digital workflows and proprietary systems that improved data management, operational scalability, and information security.

Human Resources & Payroll Coordinator | Police Athletic League, Inc. | New York, NY

Jul 2009 – Jun 2015

- Managed biweekly payroll and sensitive personnel data for 800+ employees while maintaining accuracy, confidentiality, and regulatory compliance.
- Conducted audits and reconciliations and maintained enterprise databases, strengthening financial controls, data quality, and audit readiness.

EDUCATION

Innovation Fellowship – Cybersecurity Track | The Knowledge House | Bronx, NY

Jan 2026 – Present

- Completed hands-on cybersecurity training across AWS cloud security, network defense, vulnerability management, identity and access management, incident response, and DevSecOps.
- Built and secured AWS environments using Terraform, IAM, VPC segmentation, Systems Manager, CloudTrail, CloudWatch, and VPC Flow Logs, applying Zero Trust and least-privilege principles.
- Conducted security assessments and simulated incident investigations using tools including tfsec, Suricata, Sysmon, Burp Suite, Nmap, and Athena, while automating security tasks with Python, PowerShell, and GitHub Actions.

Lehman College | Bronx, NY — Bachelor of Arts, Political Science

May 2020